



JobTrail

User guide · version 1.4

A Chrome extension that helps you grow your network, apply for jobs and keep track of it all on LinkedIn.

JobTrail is independent and is not affiliated with or endorsed by LinkedIn.

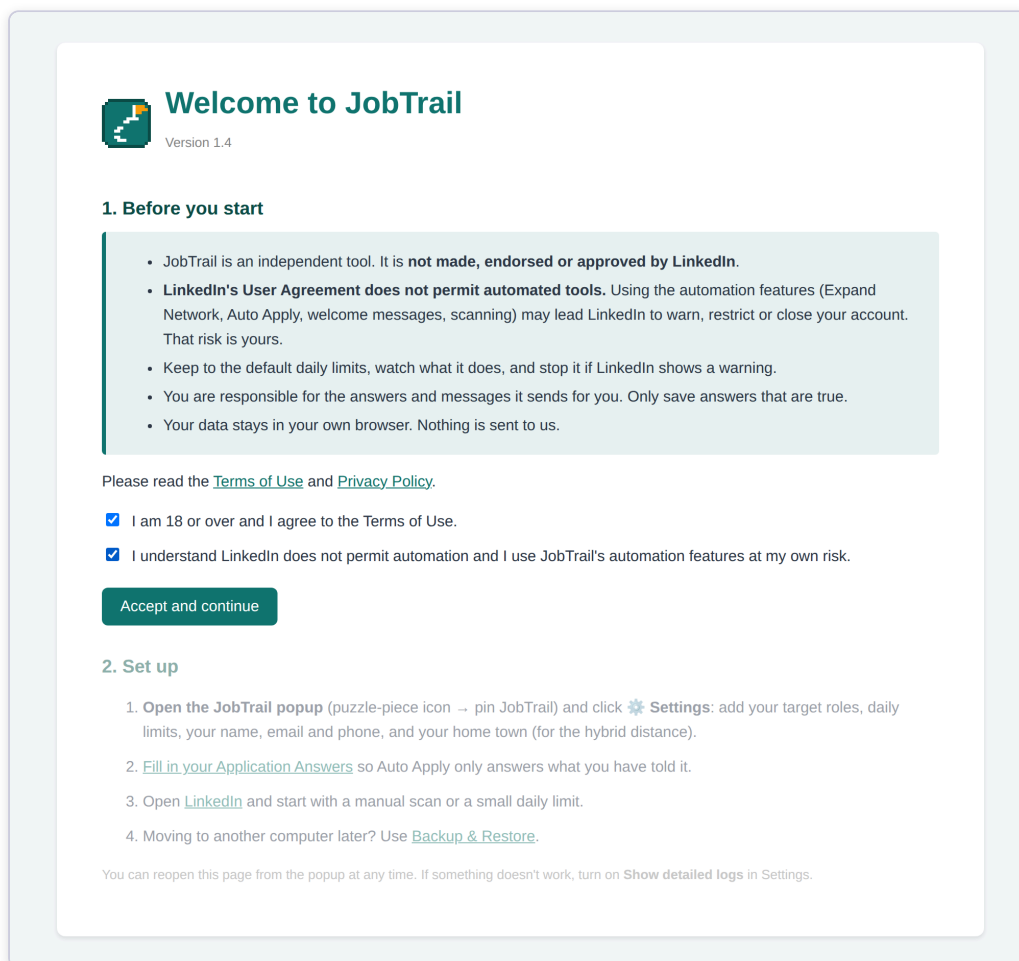
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All screenshots show example data. Everything the extension stores stays in your own browser; nothing is sent to any server.

1. Installing the extension

1. Unzip the download to a folder you'll keep, for example `Documents\jobtrail`. Don't delete this folder afterwards; Chrome runs the extension from it.
2. In Chrome, go to `chrome://extensions`.
3. Turn on **Developer mode** (top-right switch).
4. Click **Load unpacked** and choose the unzipped folder (the one containing `manifest.json`).
5. Click the puzzle-piece icon in Chrome's toolbar and pin **JobTrail** so it's always visible.
6. A **Welcome to JobTrail** page opens. Read the summary, the Terms of Use and the Privacy Policy, tick both boxes and click **Accept and continue**. Until you do, the automation buttons in the popup are greyed out.
7. Open `linkedin.com` and sign in. A small dot appears in the top-right corner of LinkedIn: the extension is active.



The welcome page on first install (reopen it any time from *Getting started* at the bottom of the popup)

Updating: replace the folder's contents with the new version, then click the ↺ refresh icon on the extension in `chrome://extensions` and reload LinkedIn. Your settings and history are kept.

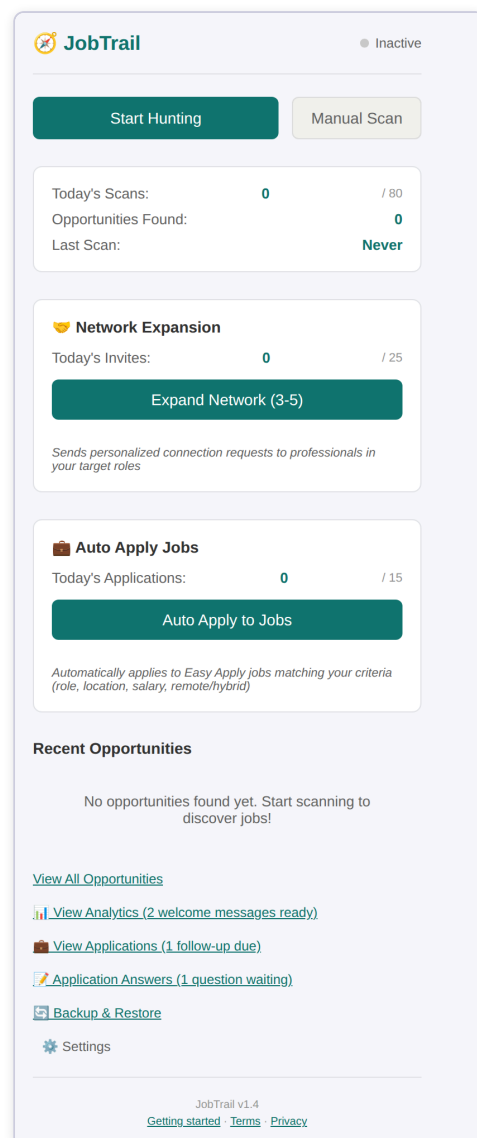
2. The popup and first-time settings

Click the extension icon while on LinkedIn to open the popup. From here you can:

- **Expand Network:** send personalised connection requests (section 4).
- **Auto Apply to Jobs:** apply to Easy Apply jobs matching your criteria (section 5).
- Open the other pages: **Analytics**, **Applications**, **Application Answers** and **Backup & Restore**.

The links show reminders in brackets, for example *(1 follow-up due)* or *(1 question waiting)*.

Start Hunting and **Manual Scan** look through your LinkedIn feed for hiring posts and list them under *Recent Opportunities*.



The popup

Settings (click  **Settings** at the bottom of the popup)

Setting	What it does
Target Roles	Job titles of the people Expand Network searches for (e.g. <i>IT Manager</i> , <i>Security Engineer</i>).
Max Daily Connection Requests	Hard daily cap on invitations. Keep to 20–30.
Connections Per Role	How many invites to send for one role before moving to the next.
Use Personalised Messages	Adds a short personal note to each invite.
Only Connect with People Actively Hiring	Uses LinkedIn's "Hiring" filter and hiring-focused wording.
Max Daily Applications	Daily cap for Auto Apply.

Target Job Roles	The job titles Auto Apply searches for and must match.
Minimum / Maximum Salary	Skips jobs whose listed salary is outside this range.
Work Types	Remote / Hybrid / On-site jobs to apply for.
Hybrid (within the distance below), Home town, Max distance	Hybrid jobs further than this many miles from your home town are skipped. Type a UK town or city; a ✓ shows it was recognised.
Full Name, Email, Phone	Used to fill in the contact details on application forms.
Daily Profile Limit, Delays, Keywords	Feed scanning: how much to scan and which words mark a hiring post.
Show detailed logs	Off normally. Turn on only when troubleshooting (see section 10).

Click **Save Settings** when you're done.

2. Settings panel (full view)

Settings

Daily Profile Limit:

Maximum profiles to scan per day (1-200)

Min Delay (seconds):

Max Delay (seconds):

Job Keywords (comma-separated):

Target Roles (comma-separated):

Network Expansion Settings

Max Daily Connection Requests:

Recommended: 25-30/day (LinkedIn allows ~100/week)

Connections Per Role (per search):

How many connections to send before switching to next role (1-10)

☒ Use Personalized Messages
Adds custom notes to connection requests (more natural)

☐ Only Connect with People Actively Hiring
Uses LinkedIn's "Hiring" filter to target recruiters and hiring managers posting jobs

☐ Show detailed logs (for troubleshooting)
Writes step-by-step progress to the browser console (F12 → Console) on LinkedIn pages

Job Application Settings

Max Daily Applications:

Maximum job applications per day (1-50, recommended: 20)

Target Job Roles (comma-separated):

Job titles to search for

Minimum Salary (£):

Leave empty for no minimum

Maximum Salary (£):

Leave empty for no maximum

Work Types:

☒ Remote

☒ Hybrid (within the distance below)

☐ On-site

Select which work types to apply for

Your Home Town:

✓ Found Maidstone

Max Distance for Hybrid Jobs (miles):

Your Full Name:

For auto-filling application forms

Your Email:

For auto-filling application forms

Your Phone:

For auto-filling application forms

Save Settings Reset to Defaults

Settings, opened from the bottom of the popup (continues in the right-hand column)

3. Application Answers

Easy Apply forms ask questions such as "*Are you legally authorised to work in the UK?*" or "*How many years of experience do you have with Linux?*". Fill these answers in once and Auto Apply uses them for every application.

- **Right to work & working arrangements:** Yes / No / Not set. *Not set* means "ask me".
- **Security clearance:** the level you hold and whether you're willing to be vetted.
- **Experience:** total years, certifications and years per skill. Add one row per skill; add alternative names as separate rows (e.g. *Azure AD* and *Entra ID*).
- **Salary & notice, education, English level, links.**
- **Your own answers:** "if the question contains *how did you hear*, answer *LinkedIn*".

Nothing is guessed. If a question has no saved answer, the application is saved as a draft and the question appears in **Questions waiting for an answer** at the top of this page. Answer it once and future applications fill it in. Use **Try a question** at the bottom to check what would be answered.

Application Answers

Auto Apply fills in Easy Apply questions from these answers. Anything left blank or "Not set" is left for you: the application is saved as a draft and the question appears below to answer once.

? Questions waiting for an answer 1

These stopped an application. Answer each one once and future applications will fill it in.

How many years of experience do you have with Splunk?
Seen 1 time - last in GRC Analyst at Northbank plc

Number

Save

Dismiss

Right to work & working arrangements

Legally allowed to work in the UK

Yes

Need visa sponsorship (now or in future)

No

Hold a full UK driving licence

Yes

Happy to commute to the job's location

Yes

Willing to relocate

Not set (ask me)

Comfortable working remotely

Yes

Comfortable working hybrid

Yes

Comfortable working on-site / in the office

Not set (ask me)

Willing to undergo background checks (DBS, references, credit)

Not set (ask me)

Have unspent criminal convictions

Not set (ask me)

Need reasonable adjustments for interviews

Not set (ask me)

Save answers

SC

Yes

Experience

Total years of work experience

12

Certifications you hold (comma separated)

ISO 27001 Lead Implementer, CISSP

Years of experience by skill

Used for "How many years of experience do you have with ...?" and "Do you have experience with ...?". A skill that isn't listed is left for you rather than guessed.

Skill or technology

Years

ISO 27001

10

x

Linux

8

x

Azure

6

x

+ Add skill

Salary & notice

Salary expectation (£ per year)

65000

Notice period

1 month

Questions about your current salary or a day rate are always left for you.

Education & language

Highest level of education

Bachelor's degree

English level

Native or bilingual

Links

LinkedIn profile URL

https://www.linkedin.com/in/...

Website or portfolio

https://...

GitHub

https://github.com/...

Your name, email and phone number come from the extension popup's settings.

Your own answers

For anything else. If a question contains the words on the left, the answer on the right is used. Answers can be Yes/No, a number, or the text of the option to pick. These are checked first.

If the question contains

Answer

how did you hear

LinkedIn

x

+ Add answer

Try a question

Check what Auto Apply would answer, using the answers on this page (including unsaved changes).

e.g. Are you legally authorised to work in the United Kingdom?

Yes / No choice

Application Answers (click **Save answers** after changes)

4. Expand Network

1. Set your **Target Roles** and daily limit in Settings.
2. On LinkedIn, open the popup and click **Expand Network**.
3. The extension searches LinkedIn for each role in turn and, with natural pauses, clicks Connect, types a short personal note and sends it. It moves to the next role after *Connections Per Role* invites.
4. It stops at your daily limit, if LinkedIn shows an invitation-limit warning, or when you click **Stop**.

Leave the LinkedIn tab open while it runs. It pauses 10–30 seconds between invites on purpose, so a run takes a while.

Free LinkedIn accounts can only add a few personalised notes a month; when LinkedIn blocks the note, the invite is sent without one.

5. Auto Apply to jobs

1. Set **Target Job Roles**, work types and salary in Settings, and fill in **Application Answers**.
2. Click **Auto Apply to Jobs**. The extension searches Easy Apply jobs, checks each title against your roles, fills in each page of the form from your saved answers and submits.
3. Applications it can't finish are saved as drafts (LinkedIn keeps its own copy too) and listed on the Applications page as *Needs completion*.

Review your Application Answers before your first run. Every answer it gives comes from what you entered, so check they're accurate.

6. Tracking your applications

- **Status:** change it from the dropdown in the table (Applied → Interviewing → Offer / Rejected / Withdrawn).
- **Timeline:** opens the history for an application, where you can add dated notes and set a follow-up reminder date.
- **Follow-ups due:** lists applications with no update after the number of days you choose (default 7). Click **Followed up** after chasing, or **Snooze 3 days**.
- **+ Add:** track an application you made outside LinkedIn.
- **What's working:** interview rates by role and by work type.
- **Export / Import CSV:** keep a spreadsheet copy or move to another computer.



Job Applications Tracker

Track every application from submission to offer, and know when to follow up

TOTAL APPLICATIONS

4

AWAITING REPLY

2

INTERVIEWING

1

OFFERS

0

NEEDS COMPLETION

1

FOLLOW-UPS DUE

1



Follow-ups due

Remind me after days without an update

Security Engineer at Acme Security
Applied, no update for 10 days

[View job](#)

[✓ Followed up](#)

[Snooze 3 days](#)

[Timeline](#)

All Statuses

All Work Types

[+ Add](#)

[Refresh](#)

[Import CSV](#)

[Export CSV](#)

JOB TITLE	COMPANY	WORK TYPE	SALARY	LOCATION	APPLIED	LAST UPDATE	STATUS	ACTIONS
Cloud Security Engineer	Brightline	REMOTE	--	Remote	25 Sept	yesterday	Needs completion	Timeline Delete
IT Manager	Penfold Ltd	ONSITE	--	Maidstone	24 Sept	2d ago	Applied	Timeline View Job Delete
GRC Analyst	Northbank plc	REMOTE	--	United Kingdom	22 Sept	yesterday	Interviewing	Timeline Delete
22 Sept 2026 Applied 25 Sept 2026 Status: Interviewing 25 Sept 2026 Phone screen booked for Tuesday Add a note (e.g. phone screen with Sarah, next round Tuesday) Add note Remind me to follow up on mm/dd/yyyy								
Security Engineer	Acme Security	HYBRID	£60,000-£70,000	London	16 Sept	10d ago	Applied	Timeline View Job Delete



What's working

From 3 submitted applications: 1 reached interview. Update each application's status as you hear back to keep this accurate. (Small numbers, so treat the rates as a rough guide.)

By target role

ROLE	APPLIED	HEARD BACK	INTERVIEWS	OFFERS	INTERVIEW RATE
GRC Analyst	1	1	1	0	100%
IT Manager	1	0	0	0	0%
Security Engineer	1	0	0	0	0%

By work type

WORK TYPE	APPLIED	HEARD BACK	INTERVIEWS	OFFERS	INTERVIEW RATE
Hybrid	1	0	0	0	0%
On-site	1	0	0	0	0%
Remote	1	1	1	0	100%

Applications tracker with a timeline opened

7. Connection analytics and welcome messages

The Analytics page shows how many invitations were sent, accepted and declined, and which roles and times work best.

- **Check Accepted Connections** (bottom of the page) visits your sent invitations and connections on LinkedIn to update who has accepted.
- **Welcome messages:** a day (adjustable) after someone accepts, a friendly message is suggested. Edit it if you like, then click **Send via LinkedIn**: a LinkedIn tab opens, the message is typed and sent, and the tab closes. **New wording** gives an alternative; **Skip** removes it from the list.

For safety, a welcome message is only sent if the conversation that opens is with that exact person. If two of your connections share the name, it asks you to message them yourself.

5

TOTAL SENT

2

ACCEPTED

2

PENDING

1

DECLINED

40%

ACCEPTANCE RATE

0h

AVG RESPONSE
TIME

 Welcome messages

Suggest a message day(s) after someone accepts

2 ready to send. Check or edit each message, then send it; it's typed into LinkedIn for you in a new tab. Use "Check Accepted Connections" below to find new acceptances.

Sarah Khan · found via "GRC" · accepted today

Hi Sarah, thanks for connecting. I'm actively looking for IT Manager or Security Engineer roles in the UK and always happy to swap notes with others in cybersecurity. If there's ever anything I can help with in return, just let me know.

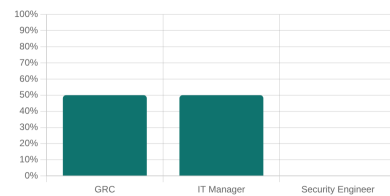
[Send via LinkedIn](#) [New wording](#) [Skip](#)

James Reid · found via "IT Manager" · accepted today

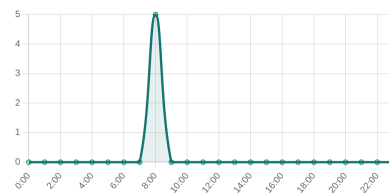
Hi James, thanks for connecting! I'm currently looking for IT Manager or Security Engineer roles and it's great to be connected with people in IT. If you ever hear of an opening that might suit, I'd really appreciate a heads-up. Hope you have a great week.

[Send via LinkedIn](#) [New wording](#) [Skip](#)

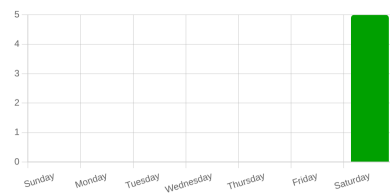
Acceptance Rate by Role



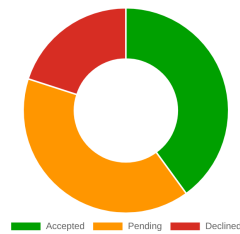
Requests by Time of Day



Requests by Day of Week



Status Distribution



Recent Connection Requests

Search by name or role...

All Statuses

All Roles

Name	Role	Sent Date	Status	Response Time	Time of Day	Welcome
Emma Wood	GRC	9/26/2026 08:54 AM	Declined	< 1h	8:00 AM	
Tom Hughes	IT Manager	9/26/2026 08:54 AM	Pending	--	8:00 AM	
Priya Patel	Security Engineer	9/26/2026 08:54 AM	Pending	--	8:00 AM	
James Reid	IT Manager	9/26/2026 08:54 AM	Accepted	< 1h	8:00 AM	To do
Sarah Khan	GRC	9/26/2026 08:54 AM	Accepted	< 1h	8:00 AM	To do

[Export to CSV](#)

[Import from CSV](#)

[Refresh Data](#)

[Check Accepted Connections](#)

[Recalculate Stats](#)

[Reset Accepted to Pending](#)

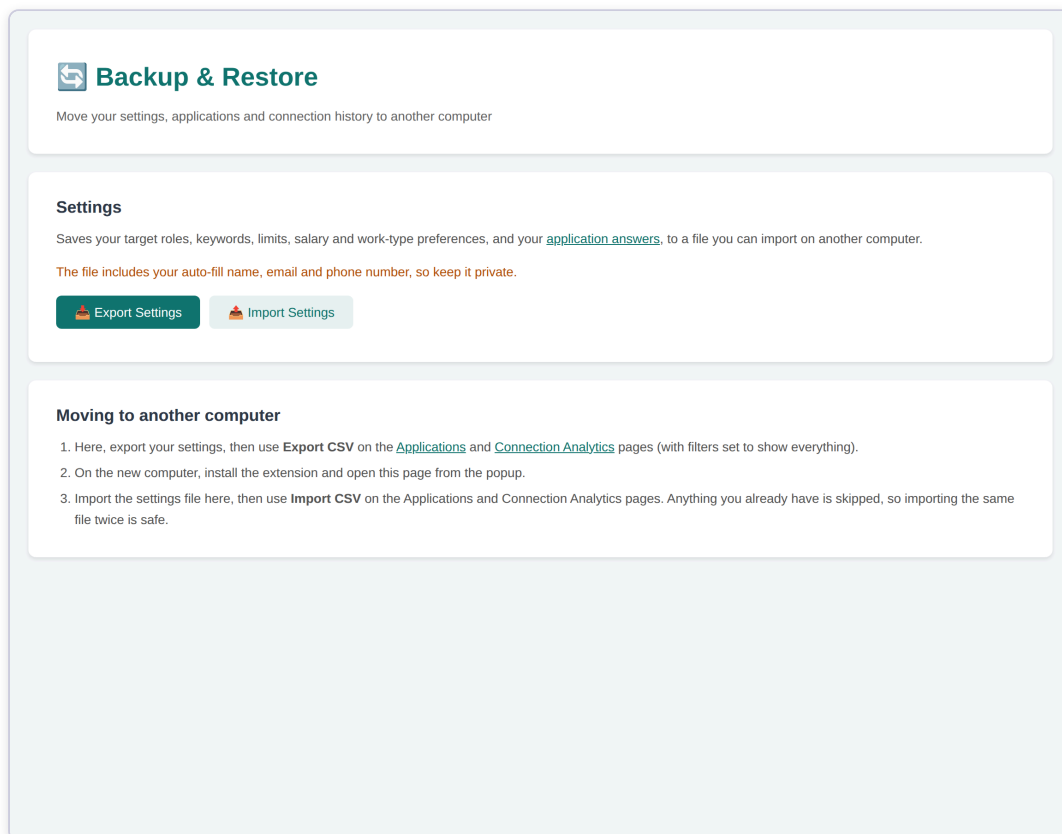
Connection analytics with the welcome-message queue

8. Backup & Restore (moving to another computer)

1. On the old computer: open **Backup & Restore** from the popup and click **Export Settings**. Then click **Export CSV** on the Applications and Analytics pages (with filters set to show everything).
2. On the new computer: install the extension, open Backup & Restore and **Import Settings**, then **Import CSV** on the Applications and Analytics pages.

Importing the same file twice is safe; anything already there is skipped. Automation stays switched off after importing until you start it.

The settings file contains your name, email and phone number. Keep it private.



Backup & Restore

9. Staying safe on LinkedIn

Important: LinkedIn's User Agreement does not permit automated tools. Using any automation carries a risk of warnings or restrictions on your account. You use JobTrail's automation at your own risk (see the Terms of Use).

- Keep daily limits low: around 20–30 invitations and 10–20 applications a day. Don't raise them to catch up.
- Don't run it all day. A session or two a day looks more natural.
- If LinkedIn shows a warning, a CAPTCHA or an invitation-limit message, stop for a few days.
- Keep your acceptance rate healthy by targeting relevant roles; many ignored invitations can trigger limits.
- Check your Application Answers are true. You're responsible for what is submitted.

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Buttons in the popup are greyed out	Click Review & accept in the popup and accept the Terms of Use.
Buttons in the popup do nothing	Reload the LinkedIn tab (the extension starts when the page loads), then try again.
"Found 0 Connect buttons"	LinkedIn may have changed its page. Turn on Show detailed logs in Settings and reload LinkedIn. Press F12 → Console, filter by <code>Network Expander</code> , and send the lines (especially <i>Page summary</i>) to support.
Many applications end up as drafts	Open Application Answers and answer the <i>Questions waiting</i> .
Settings didn't stick	Click Save Settings / Save answers before closing.
Nothing happens after updating	Click  on the extension in <code>chrome://extensions</code> , then reload LinkedIn.